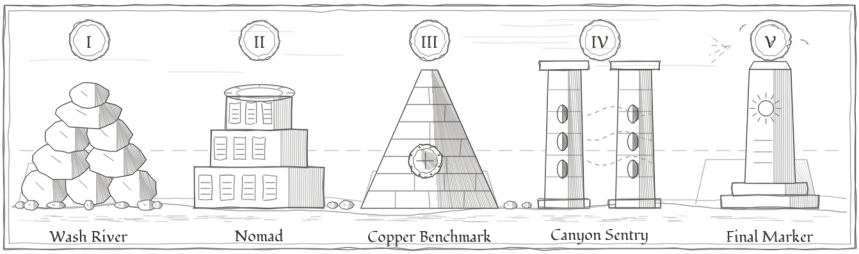
The Five Geodetic Cairns

A Surveyor's Field Sheet

I. The Markers of the Order

Long ago the Order of the Eclipse raised five markers of stone along the only firm path across the desert. Together they tie the whole map to the sun and the stars. Hermes sketched each one as he found it, and wrote down the sheet of the map where it stands.



The five Cairns in elevation. I to III stand on rebuilt stones; IV and V never fell.

II. The Survey of the Five

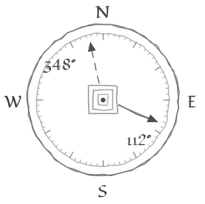
I	**The Wash River Marker** Sheet 8B · north-west, dry riverbed	A cone of river boulders half buried in the silt. Here Hermes found the First Seal.
II	**The Nomad Marker** Sheet 9A · north-east	A stepped pedestal of carved tablets, standing close to the Sun Monolith.
III	**The Copper Benchmark** Sheet 9A · north-east	A pyramid of dry stones with a copper plate. A line cut in the stone points 348° NNW.
IV	**The Canyon Sentry** Sheet 11B · south-west	Twin hollow pillars guarding the mouth of the gorge. The wind sings through them.
V	**The Final Marker** Sheet 12A · south-east	A tall monolithic pedestal before the Solstice Arch. Its line points 163° SSE to the Solar Altar.

III. The Servant's Words

What the Servant told Hermes

«Three of the five Cairns fell in the great quake of 1971, when the red storm crossed the basin. Years later a young surveyor lifted their stones again and set a copper plate beneath the third. He never knew he stood on the first foundations. Cairns IV and V, far to the south, never fell. A stone remembers the hand that raises it: that is why the first seal answered his hunch.»

Cairn III, seen from above



Solid: Hermes's copper plate, 112° E, toward Outer Watchtower VI.
Dashed: the older cut in the stone, 348° NNW, toward the Sun Monolith.

Five stones, one path.